

V1 turns contextual memory into an adaptive retrieval loop; testing determines what the system should do next



Solid = done | Orange, solid = ready to run | Dashed = happens after testing

V1 MVP: FOUR CAPABILITIES

- 1 Memory input**
Say what you remember; it extracts people, place, activity, appearance, approx. time.
- 2 Contextual candidates**
Memory > interpreted context > candidate set, not one query > results.
- 3 Recognition layer**
Filters by people, place, date, activity, visual context. No restart.
- 4 Guided recovery**
"None of these" gives next steps (add a person, search around trip dates, show beach/cafe photos), not an empty box.

WHERE INTELLIGENCE IS NEEDED

- EXPRESS**
Understand contextual memory and convert it into retrieval signals.
- MATCH / RECOGNIZE**
Combine several clues and find useful candidate and filter relationships.
- RECOVER**
Infer which retrieval strategy to try next from the previous attempts.
- LESS NEEDED: USER RECOGNITION**
The user stays the final judge of "that is the photo I meant".
AI is not claimed for every stage.

REAL TASK AND WHAT WE MEASURE

- Task: "Find a specific photo that you know exists but cannot precisely describe." No filename, date, keyword or album given.
- Retrieval success
 - Recovery rate
 - Manual browsing
 - Time to retrieval
 - Strategy switches
 - Recognition confidence

V1 TO LEARNING TO V2

V1 feature	Test / observation	What testing is designed to reveal	V2 direction
Natural-language memory input	Can users describe the photo naturally?	Which contextual clues are easiest and hardest to interpret?	Improve context extraction
Contextual candidate retrieval	Are the returned candidates relevant enough?	Which combinations of clues produce useful candidates?	Improve candidate generation
Dynamic candidate filters	Can users recognise the photo faster?	Which filters actually help recognition?	Personalise / filter dynamically
Guided recovery	What do users do after the first attempt fails?	Which recovery suggestions help users progress?	Rank recovery actions by context
IF TESTING SHOWS...			
"I don't know which filter matters" Too many plausible candidates	> V2 recommends the most relevant refinement. > Improve candidate ranking and recognition support.	Users ignore recovery suggestions Found, but long inspection	> Change the recovery mechanism, not add more suggestions. > Strengthen candidate filtering.

The middle column is what testing is designed to reveal, not a finding.

TESTING STATUS

The 30 task-based observations from discovery are behaviour research, not usability tests of this MVP. No V1 test has been run, so no success rates or quotes appear here. Replace the middle column with observed findings after the 3 sessions.

V1 question: can an adaptive retrieval loop reduce the effort to retrieve a vaguely remembered photo? V1 does not try to perfect every scenario; V2 responds to observed failure points.